ABSTRACT

YouTube has become one of the most influential platforms for digital content, with millions of videos uploaded every day. Understanding what makes a video successful can help content creators make better decisions about their content and publishing strategies. This project, “What Makes a YouTube Video Trend? – A Data-Driven Analysis,” aims to identify the patterns and characteristics associated with trending videos using the YouTube Trending Videos Stats 2026 dataset.

The dataset contains information such as video title, channel, views, likes, dislikes, comments, category, tags, trending date, and publishing time. The data will undergo cleaning and preprocessing**,** followed by Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA**)** to study relationships between video performance, audience engagement, categories, and publishing patterns. Feature engineering will also be used to derive measures such as engagement rate, like rate, comment rate, video age, and publishing time features.

The results will help identify content categories, engagement patterns, and publishing characteristics associated with trending videos. The insights will be presented using charts, graphs, and an interactive dashboard, helping content creators understand audience preferences and make more data-driven decisions when planning, publishing, and improving their videos**.**

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